

GENERAL ENGLISH (IDIOMS & PHRASES SERIES)

PRACTICE SHEET HARD LEVEL (SET 1) / ADVANCED IDIOMS & MEANINGS (30 QUESTIONS)

1. What is the meaning of the idiom: "A Pyrrhic victory"

- (A) A victory won at too great a cost, rendering it practically a loss
(B) An overwhelming military triumph with zero casualties
(C) A championship won through unfair and corrupt tactics
(D) A long-awaited success after years of continuous failure

2. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Albatross around one's neck"

- (A) A heavy, burdensome obligation or psychological penalty
(B) An expensive piece of exotic jewelry worn at galas
(C) A protective charm meant to ward off evil spirits
(D) A physical injury sustained during athletic sports

3. What is the meaning of the idiom: "An Aegean stable"

- (A) A place of extreme corruption, filth, or disorganization
(B) An ancient architectural wonder built near coastal shores
(C) A high-end equestrian training ground for racehorses
(D) A confidential government archive containing secret files

4. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Batten down the hatches"

- (A) To prepare rigorously for an impending crisis or emergency
(B) To secure cargo holds on maritime container ships
(C) To close windows tightly during severe summer heatwaves
(D) To lock office doors after working hours are complete

5. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Bête noire"

- (A) A person or thing strongly disliked, dreaded, or avoided
(B) A dark horse candidate in a competitive election
(C) A fatal flaw in an otherwise brilliant strategy
(D) A sophisticated criminal mastermind operating undercover

6. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Burning the candle at both ends"

- (A) Overworking oneself to exhaustion by keeping erratic hours
(B) Wasting financial resources on extravagant luxuries
(C) Lighting residential properties with expensive wax candles
(D) Creating hazardous conditions inside industrial workshops

7. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cast iron stomach"

- (A) The ability to eat unusual or spicy food without indigestion
(B) Extreme physical resilience against brutal physical blows
(C) Unshakeable emotional calmness under pressure
(D) A medical condition requiring surgical intervention

8. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Catch-22"

- (A) A problematic situation from which there is no escape due to contradictory rules
(B) A military regulation governing code-breaking operations
(C) A legal loophole exploited by corporate defense lawyers
(D) An emergency backup plan activated during system failures

9. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Chasing ghosts"

- (A) Pursuing an unattainable goal or investigating nonexistent leads
(B) Participating in paranormal investigations at historic sites
(C) Dealing with haunting memories of past failures
(D) Trying to communicate with deceased historical figures

10. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Crock of gold"

- (A) A vast, unexpected source of wealth or profit
(B) A mythical treasure hidden at rainbow terminals
(C) An overpriced commodity lacking intrinsic value
(D) A secure retirement savings pension fund

11. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cut the Gordian knot"

- (A) To solve a notoriously complex problem with a bold, decisive stroke
- (C) To untangle complex maritime ropes on sailing vessels

- (B) To sever business ties with dishonest corporate partners
- (D) To cancel restrictive contracts without legal penalties

12. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Damocles' sword"

- (A) An imminent, ever-present peril looming over someone
- (C) A lethal weapon used in medieval aristocratic duels

- (B) A priceless museum artifact stolen from vaults
- (D) A sharp legal indictment issued by grand juries

13. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Eat crow"

- (A) To admit a humiliating mistake and submit to public mortification
- (C) To break strict dietary restrictions under peer pressure

- (B) To consume exotic wild game during survival training
- (D) To apologize formally to political adversaries

14. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Fiddle while Rome burns"

- (A) To show criminal negligence by focusing on trivia during a major disaster
- (C) To celebrate political victories during times of social unrest

- (B) To entertain crowds with classical musical instruments
- (D) To ignore urban wildfires while attending cultural events

15. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Flash in the pan"

- (A) Something that shows initial promise but fails quickly and permanently
- (C) A brilliant scientific discovery made by accident

- (B) A sudden cooking fire erupting in kitchen fryers
- (D) A short-lived trend in fashion industries

16. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Gauntlet thrown down"

- (A) A direct challenge or invitation to enter into combat or debate
- (C) Industrial safety equipment discarded on factory floors

- (B) Heavy winter gloves discarded during blizzards
- (D) A formal resignation submitted by executives

17. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Grasping at straws"

- (A) Making desperate attempts to succeed when failure is certain
- (C) Drinking beverages through plastic tubes

- (B) Harvesting agricultural crops during droughts
- (D) Collecting construction materials for shelters

18. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Hobson's choice"

- (A) An apparently free choice with no actual alternative
- (C) A random lottery draw conducted by government agencies

- (B) A selection made between two equally brilliant career paths
- (D) A mandatory company policy enforced by executives

19. What is the meaning of the idiom: "In the doldrums"

- (A) Experiencing a period of sluggishness, depression, or inactivity
- (C) Suffering from severe winter seasonal affective disorders

- (B) Sailing through calm oceanic equatorial zones
- (D) Struggling with low financial credit ratings

20. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Juggernaut of progress"

- (A) An unstoppable, overwhelming force crushing all opposition in its path
- (C) A rapid technological advancement in artificial intelligence

- (B) A heavy industrial vehicle used in mining operations
- (D) A massive government infrastructure development project

21. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Kowtow to authority"

- (A) To act in an excessively subservient or obedient manner
(C) To protest against oppressive political regimes

- (B) To bow formally during diplomatic state visits
(D) To negotiate labor contracts with union leaders

22. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Lame duck president"

- (A) An official whose power is diminished because their departure is near
(C) An executive who lost a parliamentary confidence vote

- (B) A political leader suffering from physical health issues
(D) A corrupt official facing impending criminal prosecution

23. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Mea culpa"

- (A) An acknowledgment of personal responsibility or fault
(C) A religious confession delivered in Latin

- (B) A formal legal defense plea in criminal trials
(D) A public apology issued by corporations

24. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Nadir of one's career"

- (A) The lowest, most unsuccessful point in a trajectory
(C) The mandatory demotion following performance reviews

- (B) The final retirement year before pension collection
(D) The bankruptcy filing period of a startup

25. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Pandora's box"

- (A) A process that generates many complicated, unforeseen problems
(C) A locked vault containing classified state documents

- (B) An ancient archaeological container discovered in Greece
(D) A gift package containing dangerous explosive items

26. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Procrustean bed"

- (A) A scheme that ruthlessly enforces uniformity regardless of individual differences
(C) A medical apparatus used in orthopedic surgery clinics

- (B) An uncomfortable hotel mattress causing chronic back pain
(D) A rigid corporate structure suppressing employee creativity

27. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Quixotic quest"

- (A) Exceedingly idealistic, unrealistic, and impractical pursuit
(C) A mysterious journey into uncharted geographical regions

- (B) A medieval knightly crusade across European lands
(D) A foolish financial investment in speculative markets

28. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Scylla and Charybdis"

- (A) Two equally perilous alternatives where avoiding one exposes you to the other
(C) Two competing corporate monopolies dominating a market

- (B) Twin mythical sea monsters guarding narrow straits
(D) Opposing political factions deadlocked in parliament

29. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Swan song"

- (A) A final performance, appearance, or activity before retirement or death
(C) A poetic tribute dedicated to deceased musicians

- (B) A melancholic melody played by classical orchestras
(D) A traditional folk song sung during wildlife migrations

30. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Sword of Damocles"

- (A) A situation marked by a sense of impending danger or crisis
(C) A judicial death sentence handed down by judges

- (B) A sharp ceremonial weapon displayed in museums
(D) A military ultimatum delivered to hostile nations

ANSWER KEY (Q1 - Q30)

Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans
1	(A)	6	(A)	11	(A)	16	(A)	21	(A)	26	(A)
2	(A)	7	(A)	12	(A)	17	(A)	22	(A)	27	(A)
3	(A)	8	(A)	13	(A)	18	(A)	23	(A)	28	(A)
4	(A)	9	(A)	14	(A)	19	(A)	24	(A)	29	(A)
5	(A)	10	(A)	15	(A)	20	(A)	25	(A)	30	(A)